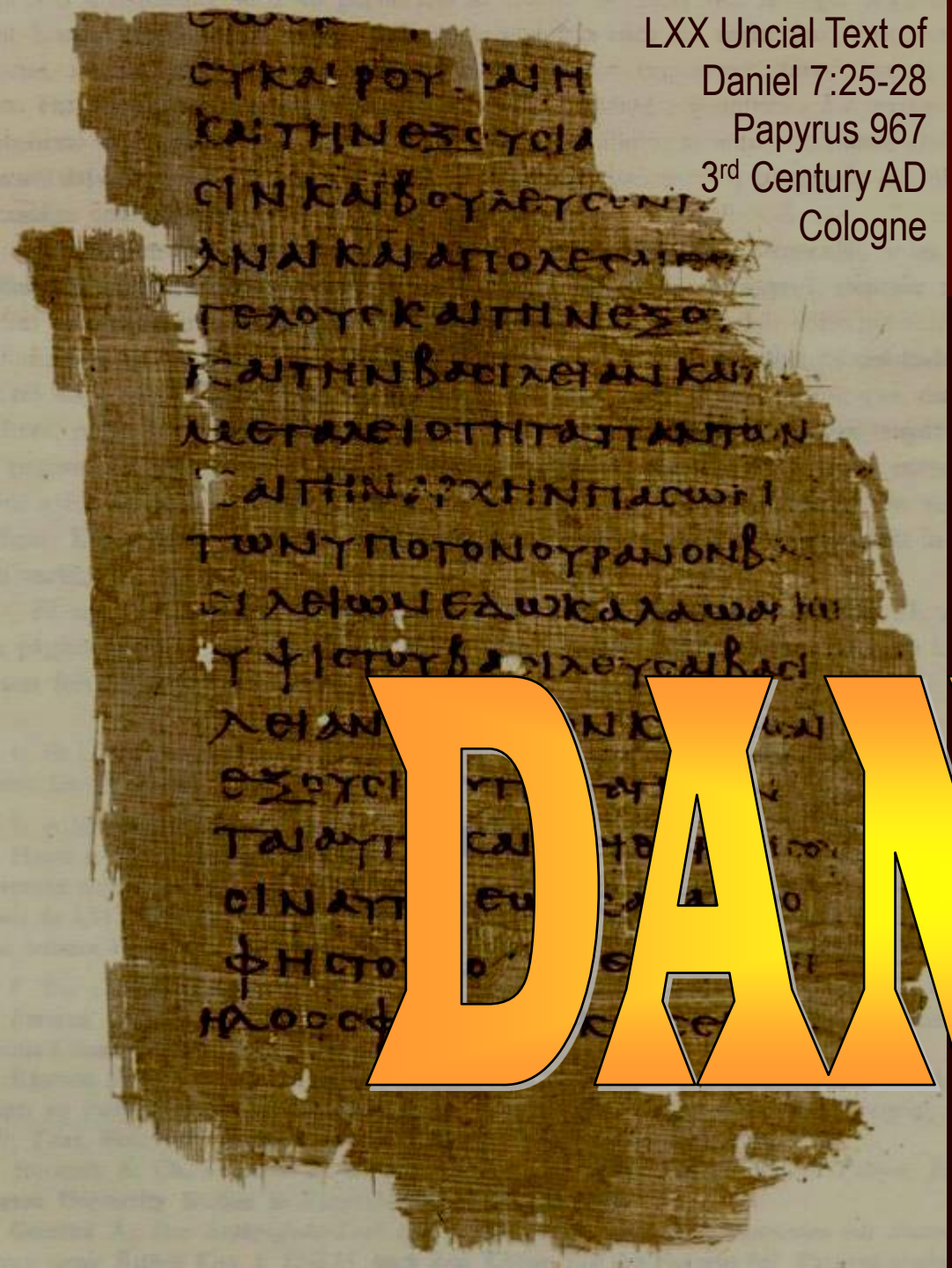

LXX Uncial Text of
Daniel 7:25-28
Papyrus 967
3rd Century AD
Cologne

Book of DANIEL

Historical Section

Daniel 1-6

The Four Young Men

their Hebrew and Babylonian names

DANIEL *(= God is my judge)*

BELTESHAZZAR *(= Lady [wife of Marduk], protect the king)*

MISHAEL *(= Who is what God is?)*

MESHACH *(= I am of no account)*

HANANIAH *(= Yahweh has been gracious)*

SHADRACH *(= I am very fearful [of a god])*

AZARIAH *(= Yahweh has helped)*

ABEDNGEGO *(= Servant of the shining one)*

NON-KOSHER ANIMALS

Leviticus 11

- Camel
- Coney (badger)
- Rabbit
- Pig
- Water creatures without fins or scales
- Eagle
- Vulture
- Osprey
- Kite (falcon or hawk)
- Raven
- Owl
- Gull
- Cormorant
- Stork
- Heron
- Bat
- Weasel
- Rat
- Lizard
- Gecko
- Skink
- Chameleon
- Snake

Maccabean "take" on Chapter 1

If one adopts either a Messianic or Dispensational view of Daniel, the story in chapter 1 is to be taken as a straightforward historical account of what actually happened in the 6th century BC.

If, on the other hand, one adopts a Maccabean view of the book, then chapter 1 is a story intended to encourage those suffering under the oppressions of Antiochus IV Epiphanes in the 160s BC.

Then the king [Antiochus IV Epiphanes] wrote to his whole kingdom that all people should be one people, and that each should give up his customs. All the Gentiles accepted the command of the king. Many even from Israel gladly adopted his religion. "And whoever does not obey the command of the king shall die."

But many in Israel stood firm and were resolved in their hearts not to eat unclean food. They chose to die rather than to be defiled by food or to profane the holy covenant; and they did die.

1 Maccabees 1:41-43a, 50, 62-63

Ashurnasirpal II, British Museum

Two Critical Interpretive Points Concerning Nebuchadnezzar's Dream:

- The head clearly represents Babylon ("you are the head of gold", 2:38b); all interpretations must begin here.
- "In the days of those kings…" (2:44):
  - *Are they the kings of the fourth kingdom?*
  - *Could they represent a fifth kingdom?*
  - *What is the nature of the kingdom that will never be destroyed?*

MACCABEAN

Head of Gold

Babylon

Chest & Arms of Silver

Media

Belly & Thighs of Bronze

Persia

Legs of Iron

Greece

Feet of Iron & Clay

Ptolemies & Seleucids

Stone Kingdom

Maccabean kingdom

MESSIANIC

Head of Gold

Babylon

Chest & Arms of Silver

Medo-Persia

Belly & Thighs of Bronze

Greece

Legs of Iron

Rome

Feet of Iron & Clay

Caesars

Stone Kingdom

Kingdom of Christ

DISPENSATIONAL

Head of Gold

Babylon

Chest & Arms of Silver

Medo-Persia

Belly & Thighs of Bronze

Greece

Legs of Iron

Rome

Feet of Iron & Clay

Kingdom of Anti-christ

Stone Kingdom

Millennial kingdom